

the often and earnest direction your Lordships have receaved to use (*sic*) those bandes appointed for the service of that Ile to be compleate and wel furnished, as also that they should not be diminished, nor taken for anie common emploiment or service. We are therefore earnestly to pray your Lordships not onlie to give presente order that the wantes and defectes as wel in the number of men as in the armor and furnishing of the aforesaid 3,000 may be thorowlie and speedilie supplied, according to the order taken in that behalfe, but likewise to cause them to be in a presente readines for the defence of the said Ile as there shalbe occacion to use them. And to th'end the said numbers hereafter may not be diminished, we are againe to require your Lordship that none of those souldiers which by roll indented are or shalbe appointed for the supplie of that Ile shal hereafter be imprested or set forth uppon anie occacion of forraine emploiment without special direction from hence.

Warning to
the traders to
the Levant.

A letter to Sir Edward Osborne, knight, and the rest of the merchantes that use the trade anie part in the Levant seas. Her Majestie being certainly advertized that the King of Spaine hath made preparation of shippes and forces to distress and set uppon those English shippes that are in the Levant seas at their retourne thorough the Straites, hath uppon this intelligence given us charge not onlie to advertize and give you warning thereof, but to will and require you to enforme your selves what number of shippes and of what sort are abroad at this time at Tripoli, Alexandry, Constantinople and other places within the Straights of the Levant seas, where unto our merchantes doe resorte. And that you do not faile to use some good and sundrie meanes to send over land to those portes and places where you shal understand or thinke yt is likely that there is any of our shippes that are to retourne hither, to give them express charge and order that they do so dispoze their busines and voiage as thei retourne together in consort and companie for there better strength

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and assurance, speciallie to appoint some place and time, though their comming home be the later, where they may meete togeather so as they may be al in one in consort at such time as they are to pass the Streightes, wherebie they may be the better able to defend themselves against the malicious purpose of th'enemy and those forces he hath prepared to annoy and distress them. Hereof we are to require you not to faile withal speed to give present order, considering how greatlie yt importeth you and them, and the greate dishonour her Majestie should receive yf his malicious purpose should take effect.

A letter to the Justices of Peace in the countie of Anglesei. Whereas Sir Richard Buckley, knight, being Deputie Lieutenant in the Isle of Anglesey, doth at this presente, by her Majestie's commaundement, repaire thither to take uppon him the charge of that Isle as heretofore he hath don, because of late he hath received some sensure in the Court of Star Chamber at the suit of Owen Wood, wherebie, yt may be, the opinion and credit of the gentleman may be called in question amongst you, her Majesty's pleasure is we should let you understand that with her good opinion and liking he is sent thither at this present time to reside there and to have the charge for the defence of that coast, and that therefore the censure he received in that Court should be no occasion to diminish his credit and reputacion with you, especiallie considering the greate provokement of the said Owen Wood, that did draw him to that which otherwise he would not have don. For which respect we are not onlie to require you that the reputacion and credit of the gentleman may be preserved in your good opinions, but to yeld him that obedience (as Deputie Lieutenant theare) which shalbe meete for the furtherance of her Majesty's service and defence of the countrie in those times of doubt and daunger.

Release of
Sir Richard
Bulkeley.

A warrant to Owen Wood commaunding him not to goe forth of his house, but to be forthcomming when he should be sent for before their Lordships to aunsweare to

such matters as he is to be charged withal, her Majestie's pleasure being such.

18^o Maij, 1591.

At Theobaldes.

The defence
of the West.

A letter to Mr. Carie of Cokingstone (*sic*). Whereas her Majesty is given to understand of somme shippes of the King of Spaine's that have bin seene in the Westernne coastes, having some intent and purpose (as yt should seeme) to make some incursions and spoiles one some part of the realme, to which end her Majestie hath alreadie given direction to her Liutenantes of the maritime counties to see the forces of those counties in a readines to withstand the attemptes and violences as may be put in practise by theemie. Forasmuch as you are Deputie Lieutenant of that countie of Devon to our vearie good Lord the Earle of Bath, her Highnes' pleasure is that you shal presentlie make your repaire thither to be there resident for the better government of the countie and accomplishment of such directions as you shall receive from hence, for the better accomplishment of her Majesty's service and defence of the said countie as occasion shal require.

A letter of the like tenour to Sir William Courtney.

The
expedition to
France.

A letter to Sir John Norreis. Forasmuch as yt is likelie that the bandes and companies under your charge may diminish and lessen in number, to th'end her Majesty may not be charged to make farther allowance then for the just number of men that from time to time shal happen to be in everie band, and as they shall be found to be ful and furnished, these shalbe therefore to require you from henceforth to cause your warrantes to be directed to the Treasurer's deputie with true certificate of the just number of so manie men as shal from time to time be found in everie bond (*sic*), that they may receive their weekly imprestes and lendings according for the number of men that shalbe in every bonde.

The lyke letter was written to Sir Roger Williams.

A letter to the Earle of Darbie. Whereas we wrott unto your Lordship about two yeares sithence to take order that yf ther should happen at any tyme occasion by soche attempt as the Kinge of Spaine might make uppon the Isle of Anglesey, uppon notice thereof geven you from our verie good Lord the Earle of Pembrock the forces which are of the trained bandes in the countie of Chester should be sent hether. Because there hath ben some discovery of certeine Spanishe forces and shipping one the seas, and it is to be doubted what course they maie take to annoy her Majestie, and theirfore Sir Richard Buckley, knight, being Deputie Lieutenant there, ys sent downe to have charge of that Isle, we have thought good to praie your Lordship to have care yf occasion shall so require by anie attempt the enemy maie make on that Isle that the force of that countie shalbe demaunded by the Lord Lieutenante or his deputie to repaire theire, that in that case your Lordship shall cause the same presently to be sent [t]hether, according to our former direction, for the saveguard and defence of that coast and repulse of the enemy.

The defence
of Anglesey.

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A letter to the Earle of Pembrock. Whereas about two yeares sithence we gave order and direction to your Lordship that the forces of the counties of Salopp, Mountgomrie, Flint, Denbighe, Carnarvan and Merioneth should be directed to repaire to the Isle of Anglesey uppon occasion of invacion or such attempt as the enemy might happen to make in those partes, because at this present there is advertisment brought to her Majestie that the Spanishe forces have ben discovered on the Westernne coast, and it is uncertaine what course they maie take to annoy her Majestie, and theirfore Sir Richard Buckley, knight, being your Lordship's Deputy Lieutenant for the said counties (*sic*), is sent downe by expresse order from her Majestie to have charge of that Isle. We have thought good to praie your Lordship to geve speciall order that the forces of the said counties maie not onlie be in a readines, but that straight

charge and commandement be geven to your Deputie Lieutenantes and all the Justices in the foresaid counties, uppon any occasion of invacion or attempt of the enemy, not to faile to make their repaire thether, according to a former direction, uppon the first firing of the beacons. And if there shalbe any unwilling to go, or remyssynes in anie by withdrawing of them selves or delainge to put them selves in order and to repaire with speed to the foresaide place as they shalbe directed, we praie your Lordship to cause those persons which shall therein be fownd anie waie fawltie or offending to be severelie punished, that others by their example maie be warned to neglect their dueties, and performe that obedience they ow to her Majesty's commandement, and the defence of their countrie. Hereof prainge your Lordship to have care for the accomplishment of this direction.

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18^o *Maij*, 1591.

At Theobalds.

Instructions
to the English
Admiral as
to the Plate
Fleet.

Matters of informacion and advise to the Lord Thomas Howard.

First, we never hard from you since you departed from the coastes of England, saving by *———, who brought home certaine Spanish prisoners bearing towards Rochel. We have bin divers times enformed of the arrival of certaine *——— from *——— before you were one the Spanish coastes, and in them was brought home for the King of Spaine 6 or 7 millions, but that the great Fleete was not come, being laden with treasure and other riches, and that they lacked men to governe the shippes, where-uppon xij^o weare lately sent out of Spaine to furnish the said Fleete, but when they are like to come home we know not, some thinking not afore September or the middest of October. For this consideration, yf your Lordship shal know

* Blank in the MS.